Worksheet for John Woodford's
"World Serpent"
by Fareen Momen
(to be used with video linked here)

Key Takeaways:

1. In Majied's illustration "*The Serpent Deceived the Whole World*," how does the artist use the figure of the World Serpent and Uncle Sam's face, to symbolize global oppression?

2. Why might Majied have chosen a biblical verse from Revelation to accompany an illustration printed in a Nation of Islam newspaper? How does this blend of Christian scripture and NOI ideology shape the message?

3. Only Arabia, labeled the "Garden of Paradise," resists the serpent's power. What is the significance of placing the only resistance in Arabia, and how does this relate to the message about "the medicine that God gives Muhammad"?

4. Dr. Woodford argues that Majied's serpent illustrates the "dynamic unity" of imperialism and racism. How does the artwork convey these two forces as interconnected rather than separate?

Contextualizing the Work

Can you think of another political cartoon, artwork, or cultural image that uses a single creature or symbol to represent a complex global threat or system (e.g., colonialism, capitalism, environmental destruction)? How does comparing your chosen example with the "World Serpent" image help you understand Majied's visual argument?